

Rowan, and what we have tried

Everything the team already knows. It is not enough to answer the question, and one of the numbers in here has a conclusion attached to it that may not survive checking.

THE PRODUCT

WHAT IT DOES

Budgets, bill reminders, a weekly summary

Users connect bank accounts, Rowan categorises spending, sets monthly budgets per category, warns before a bill lands, and emails a spending summary every Sunday. Single-user accounts only: there is no joint or shared view.

WHO USES IT

25 to 40, first salaried years

Skews to people organising their money for the first time. 68% arrive from app-store search and social, not referral.

PRICING

\$6.99 / mo · \$59 / yr

15% on annual. No free tier; 7-day trial.

SCALE

140,000 subscribers

38 people. 2 engineers available for 3 weeks.

CHURN

6.2% monthly

4.8% a year ago. ~8,700 cancellations a month.

CONSTRAINTS

Fixed for this quarter

No pricing changes. The cancel path must stay reachable in-app.

MEMO · WHAT WE HAVE ALREADY TRIED · FROM THE GROWTH LEAD, 2 SEPT 2026

WHAT	WHEN	RESULT
Pause for 3 months	Jun 2026	Offered at the cancel screen. 12% of people who reach that screen accept an offer. Company-wide cancellations moved 0.3 points, which is inside our weekly noise. Note: subscribers who accept the pause are still subscribed 90 days later 44% of the time, against 24% for those who decline. That is a 20-point gap. My read is that pause works and we should push it harder, in a bigger, harder-to-miss offer.
Exit survey	Mar 2026	Five-option dropdown on the cancel screen. 45% pick "not using it", 28% "too expensive", 15% "missing a feature", 4% "privacy concern", 9% "other".
Win-back email, day 14	Feb 2026	Sent to everyone who cancels. 1.9% reactivate. We have not tested the copy since launch.
Onboarding checklist	Nov 2025	Five steps, shown on first open. 38% complete all five. We never instrumented whether completing it changes retention, so we do not know if it worked.

THE CANCEL FLOW, PER MONTH

STEP 1

9,900

open the cancel flow

STEP 2

7,900

are shown an offer (pause or discount)

STEP 3

1,200

accept it and stay, for now

STEP 4

8,700

cancel. 6% of them ask for a refund.

44% of cancellations happen within 3 months of signup

median tenure at cancellation: 5 months

refunds requested: 6% overall, 22% on annual plans

Reviews and the data

Six verbatim reviews to point you somewhere, and the 90-day cancel-flow extract.

SIX REVIEWS · VERBATIM, FROM THE APP STORES, LAST 6 MONTHS

1 STAR · MAY

"Loved it for about a week. Then I stopped opening it, and it kept emailing me anyway."

3 STAR · MAR

"Works fine but I cannot add my joint account, which is where the money actually is."

2 STAR · APR

"It tells me I spent too much on takeaways. I know. I was there."

1 STAR · JUN

"\$7 a month to look at a pie chart."

1 STAR · JUN

"Cancelled. Not because it is bad, I just never built the habit."

2 STAR · JUL

"Took me four screens to cancel. Left a bad taste, and I would have come back later."

Six reviews are a starting point, not evidence. They tell you what to go and ask about; they do not tell you how often it happens.

THE DATA · CAPSTONE_ROWAN_CANCEL-FLOW-90-DAYS.CSV · 2,900 ROWS

A 10% random sample of everyone who opened the cancel flow in the last 90 days. One row per subscriber.

COLUMN	WHAT IT IS
plan · tenure_months	monthly or annual; months subscribed when they opened the cancel flow.
weeks_active_first_month	0 to 4. Weeks with at least one session in their first month.
sessions_prior_30d	Sessions in the 30 days before they opened the cancel flow.
offer_shown · offer_taken	pause, discount or none; whether they accepted it.
reason_selected	What they picked in the exit survey.
still_subscribed_90d	Whether they were still paying 90 days later. This is the outcome column.
refund_requested · support_ticket_30d	Whether they asked for a refund; whether they contacted support in the previous 30 days.

THREE QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING THIS DATA · NOT THE ANSWERS

1. What share of these people were barely active in their first month, and what did they pick as their reason?

2. The growth lead's 20-point gap: does it survive when you hold first-month activity constant?

3. Do the stated reasons change depending on how much someone actually used the app?

You do not need SQL or an analytics seat. Open it in a spreadsheet, or paste it into your copilot and ask in plain English. Whatever you conclude, write down the filter you used, so you can defend the number later.

WHAT IS DELIBERATELY NOT IN HERE

NO

Interview transcripts

Rowan has never run one. You recruit 3 or 4 people who cancelled a subscription app and run them yourself. Everybody knows somebody.

NO

Market or competitor research

Public, and yours to find. Two of your sources should be things a VP could click.

NO

A recommended answer

The team has one, in the memo on page 1. Treat it as a claim to check, not a conclusion to build on.